

Design System

Editorial luxury · warm cream & moss

A reference for the visual language used across riverfoxevents.com — colour tokens, typography, grid, components, navigation, forms, motion and breakpoints. All colours live as HSL custom properties in `src/index.css` and are consumed via Tailwind semantic tokens. Never hardcode colour or spacing in components.

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Brand foundations

River Fox Events is an editorial luxury party-styling brand based in Surrey. The site should feel like a magazine spread: generous whitespace, soft natural imagery, slow scroll, considered typography. Never glossy, never shouty.

Personality	Editorial · refined · warm · understated · soft motion
Voice	Considered, generous, slightly poetic. Active voice. Sentence-case headings.
Imagery	Soft natural light, neutral palettes, peach & sage accents, real moments over staging.
Don't	Pure white backgrounds · pure black text · gradients on text · drop shadows on type · serif bold weights

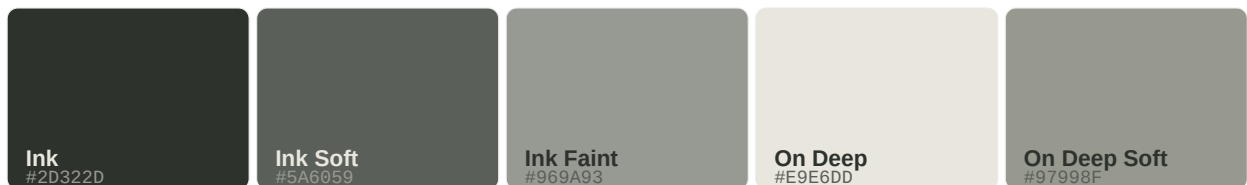
Colour

12 semantic tokens. All defined as HSL in `src/index.css` and surfaced through Tailwind classes (e.g. `bg-background`, `text-ink`, `bg-surface-deep`, `text-brand-accent`).

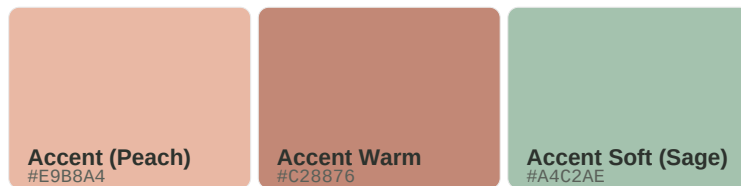
Surfaces



Ink (text)



Accents



Usage rules

- **Background** is the default page surface — NEVER use pure white.
- **Surface Alt** for cards, the form wrap, popovers, ticker strip.
- **Surface Deep** only for major dark sections (Enquire, Footer). Pair with *On Deep* text.
- **Surface Warm / Blush** alternate between light sections to create editorial rhythm.
- **Accent (Peach)** = primary CTA, focus ring, hover-link colour. **Accent Warm** = italic emphasis, ticker glyph, stars. **Accent Soft (Sage)** = secondary accent, sparingly.
- Hairlines: `hsl(-ink / 0.10)`. Stronger dividers: `0.22`.
- Minimum body-text contrast: 4.5:1. Ink on Background = 11.2:1 ✓

Typography

Three families serve distinct roles. Fraunces (variable serif) for editorial display, DM Sans for body and UI, JetBrains Mono for eyebrows and labels. Loaded once via Google Fonts in `src/index.css`.

Family	Role	Weights	Notes
Fraunces	Display, headings, quotes	300 (regular & italic)	Always weight 300. Italic + accent-warm = emphasis.
DM Sans	Body, UI, navigation, buttons	400, 500	500 for nav links and buttons; 400 for body.
JetBrains Mono	Eyebrows, mini-labels, meta	400, 600	Always uppercase, wide letterspacing (0.18–0.22em).

Type scale (clamped, viewport-responsive)

h1 / hero • 48–96px • Fraunces 300

Curated &

h1 cont. • italic em → accent-warm

considered.

h2 section • 40–60px • Fraunces 300

About the studio

RevealWord • 56–200px • Fraunces 300

Beautifully

h3 / card title • 20–24px • Fraunces 300

Children's parties

body • 15px • DM Sans 400 • 1.55 lh

DM Sans body — calm, readable, neutral

button • 13px • DM Sans 500

Start planning →

Token	Family	Size	Weight	Letter-spacing	Line-height
h1 hero	Fraunces	clamp(48, 8vw, 96)	300	-0.02em	0.95
h2 section	Fraunces	clamp(40, 4.6vw, 60)	300	-0.015em	1.05
RevealWord	Fraunces	clamp(56, 12vw, 200)	300	-0.04em	0.92
Quote (tcard)	Fraunces	21	300	-0.012em	1.45
Body	DM Sans	15 (mobile 17.5)	400	0	1.55–1.65
Button / Nav	DM Sans	13	500	0.01em	—
Eyebrow	Mono	11	400	0.18em UPPER	—
Form .lbl	Mono	9.5	600	0.22em UPPER	—

Testimonial meta	Mono	10	400	0.20em UPPER	—
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Mobile body bump

Below 760px viewport, paragraphs declared at 16px (or carrying . r f x - body - bump) are upscaled to 17.5px / 1.65 line-height for legibility on small screens. Meta and 13–15px labels remain unchanged.

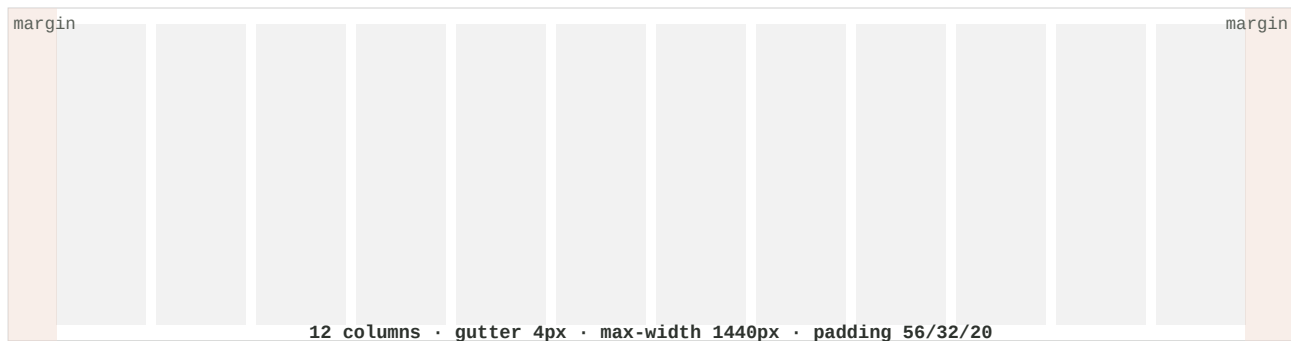
Layout & grid

Single max-width container, generous side padding, 12 implicit columns for content composition. The container class is `.container-rfx`; sections wrap content in `.rfx-section`.

Container

Property	Value
Max width	1440px
Side padding ≥ 961 px	56px
Side padding 641 – 960px	32px
Side padding ≤ 640 px	20px
Side padding 768 – 1366px (laptop)	8vw — pushes content inward
Centering	margin: 0 auto

12-column grid (visual)



Columns are not enforced via a CSS grid framework — they're a mental model. Common compositions: 6/6 (50/50 hero), 7/5 (editorial split), 4/4/4 (testimonial trio), 3/3/3/3 (experiences strip on tablet+).

Section variants

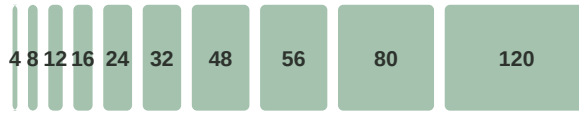
Class	Background	Text	Use for
<code>.rfx-section</code>	Background (#F1EFE8)	Ink	Default light section
<code>.rfx-section.white</code>	Surface Alt	Ink	Brighter sub-section
<code>.rfx-section.warm</code>	Surface Warm + drift blobs	Ink	About, soft moments
<code>.rfx-section.blush</code>	Surface Blush	Ink	Sage-tinted sections
<code>.rfx-section.dark</code>	Surface Deep	On Deep	Enquire, footer

Section vertical rhythm

Default section padding is 120px top & bottom. On mobile (≤ 760 px) it collapses to 56px. On laptop (768–1366px) it tightens to 80px so every section hints at the next without large gaps.

Spacing & radius

Spacing scale (Tailwind 4px base)



Common increments (px). 4–24 for inline spacing, 32–56 for component blocks, 80–120 for section vertical rhythm.

Border radius scale

0	Hairlines, dividers, ticker strip
3px	Tight corners (pricing tag)
6px	Buttons (.btn-solid-rf, .btn-ghost-rf)
8–10px	Form fields (.form-row), pricing cards
14px	Form wrap (.form-wrap)
18–22px	Imagery on desktop (mobile clamps to 18px)
50% / pill	Circular icon backgrounds, scroll cue

Shadows

Card resting	<code>0 1px 0 ink/0.04, 0 24px 60px -28px ink/0.18</code>
Card hover	<code>0 1px 0 ink/0.04, 0 36px 80px -30px ink/0.28</code>
Form wrap	<code>0 30px 80px -20px rgba(24,27,24,0.22), 0 8px 24px -10px rgba(24,27,24,0.10)</code>
Popover (nav)	<code>0 24px 60px -20px hsl(var(--ink)/0.22)</code>

Buttons

Four button variants. Each uses DM Sans 500 / 13px and the signature *gap-grow* + *arrow-slide* hover (gap 12 → 18px over 400ms eased). Always pair the label with a trailing arrow glyph →.

Solid · dark (primary)

.btn-solid-rf

Anatomy

Background: ink (#2D322D) · Text: background (#F1EFE8) · Padding: 14×22 · Radius: 6px · Gap: 12px between label and arrow.

Hover state

Background → pure black · Gap 12 → 18px (arrow slides 4px) · transition 400ms cubic-bezier(.25,.46,.45,.94).

When to use

Default page-level CTAs on light backgrounds. One per section.

Start planning →

Solid · accent (peach)

.btn-solid-rf.accent

Anatomy

Background: accent (#E9B8A4) · Text: ink · same padding & radius as solid-dark.

Hover state

Background → deeper peach hsl(12 55% 70%) · Gap 12 → 18px.

When to use

Hero CTA, nav CTA, in-section CTAs that need warmth over weight.

Start planning →

Ghost (outline)

.btn-ghost-rf

Anatomy

Transparent background · Border: 1px ink/30% · Text: ink · padding 13×22.

Hover state

Background → ink (fills) · Text → background (cream) · gap grows.

When to use

Secondary action sitting next to a solid button.

View services →

Inline link

.btn-link-rf

Anatomy

No background · 1px underline = currentColor · 10×0 padding · gap 10.

Hover state

Gap 10 → 18px (arrow slides). No colour change.

When to use

Quiet tertiary actions inside copy or beneath cards.

Read the brief →

Navigation

Fixed top navigation, full-width, three-column grid: left links · centred logo · right CTA. Translucent background with backdrop-blur.



Visual reference (not pixel-accurate)

Anatomy

Property	Value
Position	fixed top, full-width, z-index 100
Padding	22px vertical · 56px horizontal (mobile: 16×22)
Layout	CSS grid · 1fr / auto / 1fr
Background	hsl(--background / 0.82) · backdrop-blur(18px) saturate(1.05)
Background scrolled	hsl(--background / 0.94)
Bottom border	1px hsl(--ink / 0.10) · 0.12 when scrolled
Transition	background, blur, border-color · 500ms ease
Link font	DM Sans 400 · 13px · color: ink
Logo wordmark	DM Sans 500 · 15px · letter-spacing 0.22em UPPER
Logo subline	JetBrains Mono · 9px · 0.3em tracking · 'SURREY'
CTA (right)	.btn-solid-rf.accent · py-2 px-4 · 12px

Link interaction

Each nav link renders an underline that grows from left → right on hover (scaleX 0 → 1, transform-origin: left, 500ms cubic). The underline is a 1px : : after pseudo using currentColor — opt out by adding .no-underline-fx.

Services dropdown

Hover-revealed popover. 240px min-width · Surface Alt background · 1px ink/10% border · 16px (rounded-2xl) radius · 60×20px deep shadow · 12px vertical padding. Items: 13px DM Sans, 20×10 padding, hover underline. 140ms hover-out delay prevents flicker between trigger and panel.

Mobile (≤760px)

Left links and right CTA hide. A two-line hamburger toggle appears right-aligned with the label "Menu" / "Close" in mono uppercase. Tapping opens a full-screen drawer over the page (z-index 99). Links render in Fraunces 40px and stagger-fade-in at 60ms intervals. Body scroll is locked while open.

Forms

Editorial, generous, obvious tap targets. Form lives inside a .form-wrap on Surface Alt with deep soft shadow; fields are .form-row with a tiny mono label above the input.

YOUR NAME

Sarah Chen

EMAIL

sarah@studio.co.uk

EVENT TYPE

Children's party ☒

EVENT DATE

12 / 06 / 2026

Resting · resting · default · focused (peach ring)

Form wrap

Background	Surface Alt (#FCFBF7)
Border	1px hsl(--ink / 0.08)
Padding	36px (mobile 20px)
Radius	14px (mobile 12px)
Shadow	0 30px 80px -20px ink/0.22, 0 8px 24px -10px ink/0.10
Grid	form-grid: 2 columns, 14×16px gap (mobile: 1 column, 12px gap)

Field (.form-row)

Background	Background (#F1EFE8)
Border	1.5px hsl(--ink / 0.12)
Radius	10px
Padding	10px 16px
Label	JetBrains Mono 600 · 9.5px · 0.22em · UPPER · ink-soft
Input	DM Sans 500 · 15px · ink · placeholder ink-faint
Hover	Border → ink/0.28 · background → Surface Alt
Focus	Border → accent (peach) · 3px hsl(--accent / 0.14) ring
Textarea	min-height 96px · resize: vertical
Select	Custom chevron SVG inline · cursor pointer

Cards & surfaces

Testimonial card (.tcard)

Background	Surface Alt
Border	1px hsl(--ink / 0.08)
Padding	38 34 32
Radius	6px
Shadow	0 1px 0 ink/0.04, 0 24px 60px -28px ink/0.18
Hover	translateY(-4px) · shadow deepens to 36×80×30 ink/0.28
Stars	Accent Warm · 20px · 6px gap
Quote	Fraunces 21 / 1.45 · 300 weight · -0.012em
Meta	Mono 10px UPPER · top divider 1px ink/0.10 · 22px padding
Name	Fraunces italic 16px · -0.01em (sentence case)

Experience card (.exp-card)

Image wrap	.exp-img-wrap · overflow hidden · custom property --hover-zoom
Image hover	scale(1) → scale(1.12) over 1.2s eased
Overlay	Linear gradient ink/0 → ink/0.78, opacity 0 → 1, mix-blend multiply
CTA	Absolute · left 22 · bottom 18 · DM Sans 700 · 15px · cream
CTA reveal	translateY(8px) opacity 0 → translateY(0) opacity 1 (500ms)
Title hover	Color shifts to accent (peach) over 300ms

FAQ accordion

Library	Radix Accordion (.faq-rf-trigger / .faq-rf-content)
Open icon	.faq-rf-plus rotates 0 → 45° (closed → open)
Open anim	480ms cubic-bezier(0.22, 1, 0.36, 1) — height 0 → auto + opacity
Close anim	380ms cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 0.2, 1)

Ticker (.ticker-strip)

Track	Infinite marquee · 60s linear · width: max-content
Item	Fraunces 22–36px clamped · 300 weight · 56px gap
Glyph	::after content '*' in Accent Warm at 0.45em
Borders	1px hsl(--ink / 0.10) top & bottom · 22px vertical padding

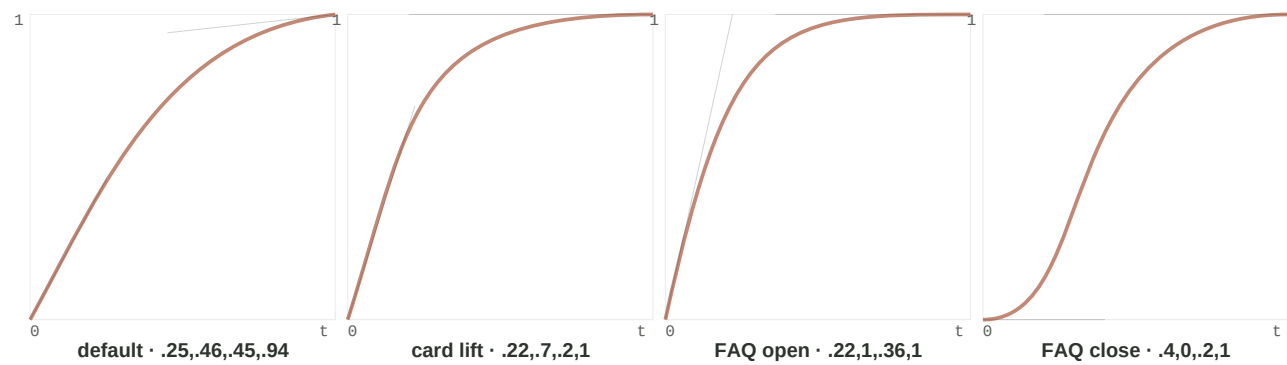
Imagery

Format	WebP, q80, Lanczos resampled
Hero	Max width 900px · object-fit cover
Experience cards	820px wide · 4:5 portrait or 3:4
Studio portrait	1024px wide · 3:4
Radius	Desktop 18–22px · mobile clamps to 18px
Treatment	Soft natural light · neutral palettes · no heavy filters
Parallax	Subtle vertical drift via useImageParallax hook
Loading	loading='lazy' below the fold · explicit width/height attributes
Placeholder	.ph + .ph-warm / .ph-blush / .ph-dark — diagonal stripe texture

Motion

Slow, eased, never bouncy. The site uses Lenis for smooth scrolling (see useSmoothScroll). Native browser smooth-scroll is disabled.

Easing curves



Common animations

Reveal-up (.fade-up)	20px lift, opacity 0.2 → 1, 1s default ease. Never starts fully invisible.
Word reveal	Per-word translateY(110%) → 0, 1.1s eased. Italic 'em' words use Accent Warm.
Hero scroll cue	Bouncing chevron · 2.2s ease-in-out infinite (8px translateY).
Warm section blobs	Two blurred radial gradients drift 22s & 26s alternate. Disabled when prefers-reduced-motion.
Pricing shimmer	Gradient stroke sweeps 5.5s linear infinite (popular tier only).
Page transition	PageTransition wraps route changes — opacity + small Y translate.

Breakpoints

Range	Container	Section pad	H1 cap	Notes
≤ 640	20px	56px	—	Body bumps 16 → 17.5px · 1-col forms · mosaic stacks
641 – 760	32px	56px	—	Tablet stack · drawer nav still active
761 – 767	32px	120px	—	Edge case · usually skipped by viewport
768 – 1366	8vw	80px	72px	Laptop scaling · hero ≤ 85vh · RevealWord ≤ 64px
≥ 1367	56px (max 1440)	120px	96px	Full editorial scale

Code reference

Tailwind semantic classes (preferred over hex)

bg-background / text-foreground	Default surface + text
bg-surface-alt	Card / form surface
bg-surface-deep / text-on-deep	Dark sections
bg-surface-warm / .blush	Tinted sections
text-ink / text-ink-soft / text-ink-faint	Text hierarchy
text-brand-accent / bg-brand-accent	Peach accent
text-accent-warm	Italic emphasis · stars
border-border	Default 0.12 ink hairline

Custom utility classes

.container-rfx	Site container, max 1440px, responsive padding
.rfx-section[.dark .white .warm .blush]	Vertical section + variant
.font-serif-rf	Fraunces 300 with descender padding
.eyebrow	Mono uppercase mini-label
.hairline	Full-width 1px divider
.btn-solid-rf[.accent] / .btn-ghost-rf / .btn-link-rf	Buttons
.form-wrap / .form-grid / .form-row / .lbl	Form scaffolding
.tcard / .exp-card / .ticker-strip	Components
.fade-up / .word-reveal-mask	Reveal animations
.rfx-shimmer-stroke	Animated gradient border (popular pricing)

Files

<code>src/index.css</code>	All tokens, components, utilities, animations
<code>tailwind.config.ts</code>	Tailwind colour mapping + animation registration
<code>src/components/rfx/*</code>	All page-level brand components
<code>src/hooks/useSmoothScroll.ts</code>	Lenis smooth-scroll initialiser
<code>src/hooks/useImageParallax.ts</code>	Subtle image parallax driver